



mac book recovery mode keys

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How to Enter macOS Recovery Mode on a Mac

The key combination depends on whether you have an Apple Silicon (M1/M2/M3/M4/M5 and later) or Intel-based Mac.

Apple Silicon Macs (M1, M2, M3, M4, M5 and later)

1. **Shut down** your Mac completely (hold power button for up to 10 seconds if it won't shut off).
2. **Press and hold the power button** as the Mac starts up.
3. When you see "Loading startup options" or the **Options** icon, **release the power button**.
4. Click **Options**, then **Continue**.
5. Select your startup disk (e.g., Macintosh HD) and click **Next**.
6. If prompted, select a user and enter their password to log in [Apple Support +1](#).

Tip: On Apple Silicon, there's no Command+R key combo — just hold the power button until startup options appear.

Intel-based Macs

1. **Shut down** your Mac (hold power button for up to 10 seconds if needed).
2. **Press and hold Command (⌘) + R** immediately after turning it on.
3. Keep holding until you see the **Apple logo** or a **spinning globe**.
4. Release the keys and wait for the **macOS Utilities** window to appear [Apple Support +1](#).

Optional: You can also use:

- **Option (⌥) + Command (⌘) + R** — Internet Recovery (downloads the latest macOS version from Apple's servers).
- **Shift + Option (⌥) + Command (⌘) + R** — Internet Recovery with verbose mode [Apple Support](#).

What You Can Do in Recovery Mode

Once in Recovery, you can:

- **Reinstall macOS** (without erasing data unless you choose to erase the disk).
- **Restore from Time Machine** to roll back to a previous backup.
- **Use Disk Utility** to repair or erase the startup disk.
- **Reset NVRAM/PRAM** (Option + Command + P + R).
- **Access Terminal** for advanced commands [Apple Support +1](#).

Note: Recovery Mode itself doesn't delete your data, but reinstalling macOS or erasing the disk will. Always back up important files before making changes.

If your Mac won't boot normally, these steps can help you troubleshoot, reinstall, or restore your system.

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Mac startup key combinations - Apple Support

Learn about the Mac features and tools that you can access by holding down one or more keys during startup.

Find out if you have a Mac with Apple silicon

1. Turn on your Mac and continue to press and hold the power button as your Mac starts up.
2. Release the power button when you see...

Guidelines for using these key combinations

• Press and hold all keys in the combination together, not one at a time. • If you can't get a key combination to work when restarting your Mac, shut down your Mac first. If yo...

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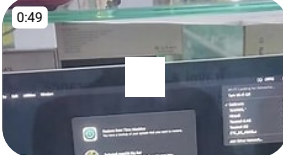
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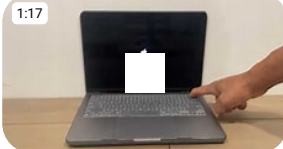


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